

SDC Data Visualization Guidelines

Working document

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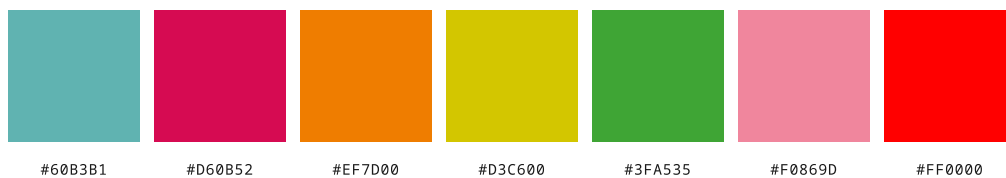
Colours

The palettes below are for **encoding data only** — bars, lines, pie slices, map areas. Colours for chart *elements* (axes, gridlines, labels) are handled separately, later.

Every palette is shown at **7 colours** so the full set is visible. In practice a categorical palette stays readable up to about **5–6 categories**; beyond that, colours become hard to tell apart, including for colour-blind readers.

Current palette

The categorical palette from the EDA strategy — our starting point and baseline for comparison.

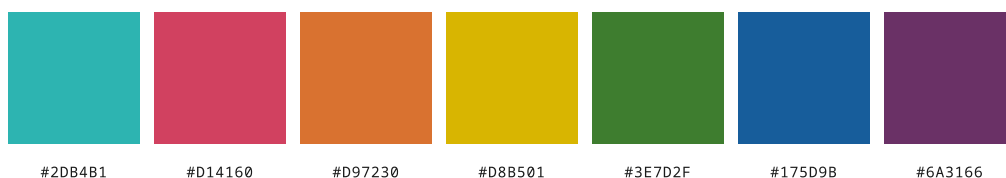


OKLCH

Built on a perceptual lightness staircase in OKLCH: same teal and pinkred anchors, with the light-pink and pure red swapped for a blue and a violet.

Pro: even lightness, more colour-blind-robust, works in black & white.

Con: slightly more muted — loses some of the current palette's .



Bright one

The same hues pushed higher in chroma for a livelier, near-neon feel.

Pro: punchy and high-energy, strong on screen.

Con: reads less institutional and can strain the eye in large filled areas.

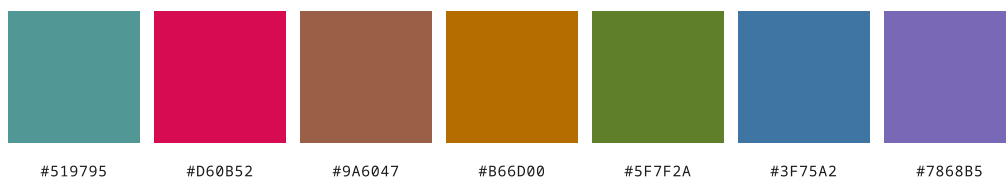


GPT one

A muted, earthy take: desaturated naturals (brown, gold, olive) alongside the teal and pinkred anchors.

Pro: soft, cohesive, easy on the eye for large filled areas.

Con: lower chroma makes some hues harder to tell apart at small sizes, and it feels less lively.

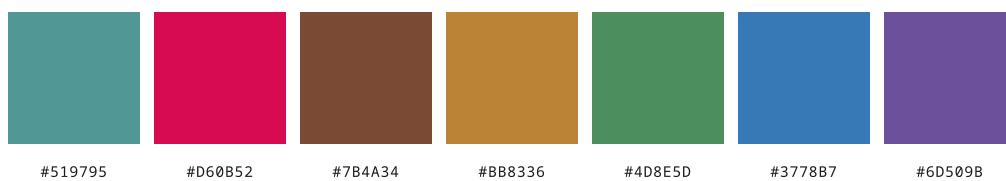


Claude one

Similar earthy direction, but engineered so every colour clears a minimum contrast on white and the lightness steps stay ordered.

Pro: accessible and well-balanced, dependable across chart types.

Con: the darker, contrast-driven hues compress the range and can look a little sober.

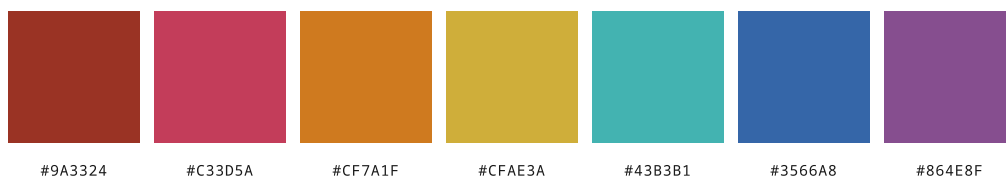


Warm one

Leans warm: two or three neighbouring hot hues (brick, pinkred, orange, gold) before spreading to cool accents.

Pro: cohesive, warm identity.

Con: the warm cluster risks similar lightness, reducing how many colours truly stand apart.

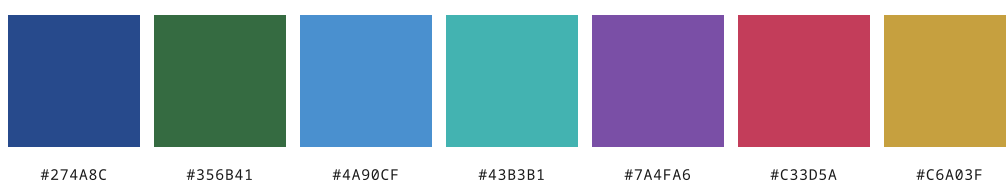


Cool one

The mirror of warm — anchored in blues, greens and teal, with warm colours only as accents.

Pro: calm and institutional.

Con: the cool cluster can look samey and less energetic.



Typography

Layout

Icons